

Exotic names such as Lian Li, Xoxide, Chieftec etc. are not available with local dealers in India, so there is little point in talking about them. What is available here, though, is Coolermaster, Thermaltake, and Antec.

Antec is renowned worldwide for their sturdy PC cases and great power supplies, and for our top-of-the-line PC, we will talk about nothing less than Antec. From the Performance One range of Antec Towers, we chose the Antec P180.

The primary reason being availability, and the second being the innovations featured within. This case has a separate chamber in which the power supply resides, so as to isolate the heat of the power supply from the rest of the system and lower the system noise. Other features include a three-layer (aluminium-plastic-aluminium) side panel that ensures the case remains quiet when the tension is high and when the slightest noise can destroy your game. Priced at Rs 10,500, this cabinet is a must-have if you can afford it. Before we forget, the case comes without a power supply, so you need to make sure you choose the right power one. This is what we talk about next.

The Power Supply

This is a difficult component to decide on. There are plenty of power supply vendors in the market who will talk about 400 W–450 W power supplies available at half the rate of branded ones. Beware of such power supplies, since the promised power is never attained. The thing to look for is the 12 V rail, which should have a current rating of 18 A and above. The higher the better.

Branded power supplies such as the Antec Truepower or Phantom series or the ThermalTake PurePower series go on to provide dual 12V rails that have a power rating of 20A each! That is more than enough for four hard drives on RAID, two optical drives, two video cards with power connectors (think SLI) and the regular stuff including the motherboard and other components; and you still have power to spare! However, if you are not satisfied